SKYBOUND COURIER

Mobile Video Game Storyboard — Assignment 7

Genre: Action-Adventure Puzzle | Platform: Phone and Tablet | Screen: Sideways (Landscape)

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Part 1: Story Idea

A young flying messenger named Mira finds out that the magic wind engines holding up her floating city are breaking, one by one. She must fly between islands to fix them before her home falls out of the sky.

Why it's interesting: the world itself works like a countdown clock. Every broken engine means an island is really falling, so exploring and racing against time are part of the world.

Part 2: Premise

The player controls Mira Windsong, a 14-year-old flying messenger in a world called the Skyreach Archipelago, a group of floating islands held up by old wind engines. The problem is that the wind engines are breaking one by one, and the islands are slowly falling from the sky. To win, you must fly, dash, solve wind puzzles, and fix each engine before its island falls.

Part 3: Player Fantasy

You become a brave flying messenger who rides the wind itself — gliding off cliffs, dashing through gaps, and outrunning falling platforms. It feels like being small and fast in a huge, breaking world, and smart enough to figure it out.

Who you become: A quick messenger who trusts flying more than standing still.

Special powers: Gliding, a short Wind Dash, and later, the power to control air currents.

Feelings you should have: Excitement while flying, tension as islands break apart, pride after solving a puzzle, and warmth during quiet character moments.

What makes you feel powerful, smart, or brave: Dashing through a closing gap at the last second, and solving a wind puzzle that saves a whole island.

Part 4: Main Game Ideas

1. Smooth Flying and Dashing
Gliding and quick dashes need to feel easy and fun using just one thumb.

2. Solving Simple Puzzles
Each engine room has a small puzzle to solve using wind, gears, and light.

3. Exploring While Racing Against Time
Players can explore floating islands, but the islands are slowly breaking apart. This makes players curious while still keeping the game exciting.

4. Small Story Choices
Small choices, like who to help first or whether to trust Kael, change how the story ends without making the game too complicated.

Why each idea matters:

- Flying is the main thing you do, so it needs to feel great first.
- Puzzles give flying a purpose and make each level harder step by step.
- Exploring rewards players who take their time, which fits short mobile play sessions.

- Choices make the ending feel meaningful without needing a huge, complicated story.

Part 5: Characters and World

Main Character

Name: Mira Windsong

Looks: Thin and quick, windblown hair tied in two, flight goggles on her forehead, a patched flying suit covered in wind symbols, and a bag full of delivery scrolls.

Personality: Curious, quick to act, and very loyal. She talks to herself while flying and never says no to a dare.

Goal: Fix the wind engines and save the islands before they fall.

Strength: Amazing reflexes and a natural feel for the wind.

Weakness: She secretly hates standing still — she gets nervous when she can't move or fly. The story slowly helps her get over this.

Special power: Wind Dash — a short burst of speed that changes her direction mid-air. Later, she gets a double-dash and a windshield.

Supporting Character

Name: Tobb Calder

Role: A retired wind engineer who now helps Mira over the radio, turning old engine instructions into simple steps.

Relationship with Mira: A tough but caring mentor. He used to work with Mira's father, and he treats her like family.

Antagonist / Main Problem

Name: Kael the Stormbound, once the head engineer of the islands.

Goal: Kael believes the wind engines are unnatural, so he is deliberately breaking them. He wants a dangerous storm called the Hollow Current to take over the islands and “reset” the world.

Why he's dangerous: He controls swarms of evil wind creatures called Wisps, knows the engines better than anyone, and truly believes he's doing the right thing — which makes him hard to simply beat.

Game World

Location: The Skyreach Archipelago, a group of islands floating above a sea of clouds.

Time: A fantasy world with steam machines and clockwork, powered by wind magic.

Look: Warm, painted style, sunlight through clouds, with brass, copper, and patched cloth textures.

Important places: Windmill Spire is Mira's home, and it's also where you learn how to play. Market Isle is a busy island where people buy, sell, and talk. Cloudmist Caverns are dark caves with secrets and tricky challenges. The Sunken Engine Core is an old, broken engine area Mira must explore. And Storm's Edge is the most dangerous place, where the big storm is strongest.

Rules of the world: Floating islands stay in the sky because their wind engines keep them up. The engines need Windstones to keep working. If Mira falls from an island, she does not die, but she loses time and Windstones because she is carried down by a lower wind current.

Dangers: The dangers include falling and breaking platforms, corrupted wind creatures called Wisps, sudden strong downward winds, and the growing Hollow Current storm that threatens the islands.

Useful items: Windstones are special stones used as fuel for engines and as money. Updraft Vents are wind boosts placed around islands that help Mira fly higher and travel faster.

Part 6: Story Structure

Beginning

Mira is a courier delivering a normal package when the Windmill Spire's engine suddenly breaks for the first time ever. Tobb guides her by radio and teaches her to glide and dash while she fixes it. The island is saved, but Tobb warns her that other islands are breaking too.

Middle

Mira travels to Market Isle and Cloudmist Caverns, where more engines fail. She learns new moves — the double-dash and wind shield — and finds a journal that mentions Kael. At the Sunken Engine Core, she learns the truth: Kael is breaking the engines on purpose because he believes the wind magic is wrong.

Ending

Mira reaches Storm's Edge and finally faces Kael inside the storm. This last challenge uses everything she's learned — flying through falling debris, dashing past Wisps, and solving one final wind puzzle to reach him. She has to make a big choice: fight Kael, or try to reach the good person he used to be. Her choice decides whether the storm is destroyed or calmed down, and whether Kael is defeated or saved — giving the story either a happy ending or a bittersweet one.

Part 7: Levels

Five levels, getting harder step by step — starting with an easy tutorial, moving into open exploration, then puzzles and fighting, a big turning point, and finally a boss fight.

Level	Place	Main Goal	New Thing to Learn	Story
1	Windmill Spire (Mira's home)	Learn to glide and dash; deliver a package	Hold to glide, swipe to dash	Mira and the world are introduced; the engine breaks for the first time
2	Market Isle	Save stranded traders and collect Windstones	Wind puzzle: redirect gusts to open blocked paths	Mira learns the problem is spreading to other islands
3	Cloudmist Caverns	Cross dark caves without falling	First fights and dodging against Wisps, with limited light	Mira finds a journal that hints at what Kael did
4	The Sunken Engine Core	Restart three engines before the Core collapses	Puzzles and platforming with a countdown timer	Big turning point: Kael is breaking engines on purpose
5	Storm's Edge	Reach the storm's center and face Kael	Final boss fight using everything learned so far	The ending: Mira chooses to fight Kael or save him

Part 8: Gameplay Steps

Gameplay steps for Level 4 — The Sunken Engine Core:

- Mira enters through a broken doorway
- Goal: fix three engines before time runs out
- She explores the broken engine room, flying between walkways
- She finds a key to open the first engine
- She dodges hot steam while crossing a narrow beam

- She solves a gear puzzle to fix the first engine
- A Wisp attacks when the engine turns on, and she fights it
- She sees a memory of Kael explaining why he broke the engines
- She learns a new move, Double Dash, to reach the second engine
- She chooses: save a trapped worker, or hurry ahead
- She finishes by fixing all three engines
- She's rewarded with the Double Dash move and a cutscene about Kael's plan

Why these steps fit the game's main ideas or your pillars:

- Exploring and collecting fits “explore while racing against time”
- The gear puzzle and fixing engines fit “solving puzzles”
- Dodging steam and fighting the Wisp fit “smooth flying”
- The worker choice fits “small story choices”

Part 9: Gameplay Flowchart

Flowchart for Level 2 — Market Isle:

START

↓

Goal: find the stranded traders

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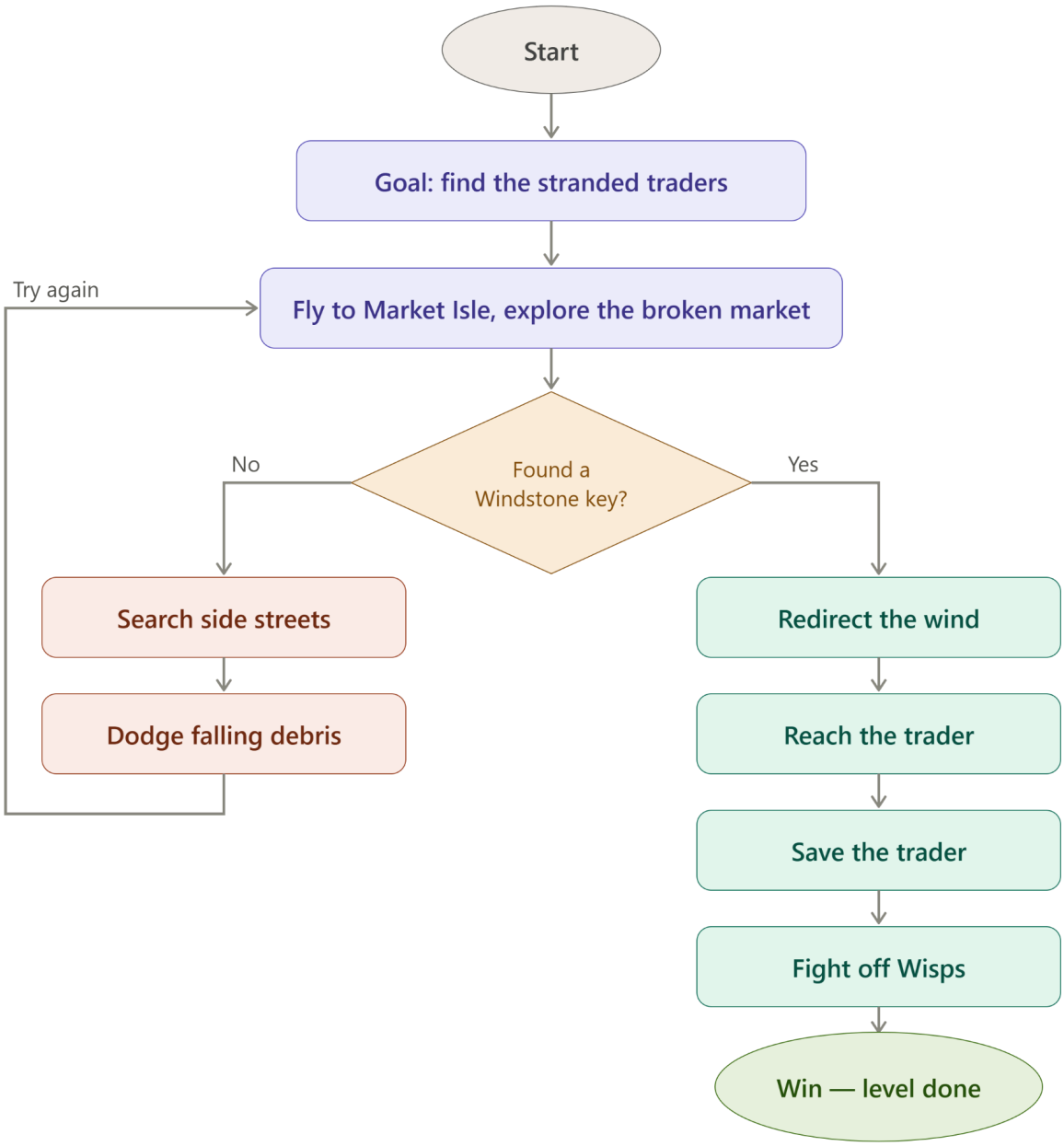
Fly to Market Isle and explore the broken market

↓

QUESTION: Did you find a Windstone key?

YES	NO
Redirect the wind → reach the trader → save them → fight off Wisps → win → LEVEL DONE	Search side streets → dodge falling debris → go back and try again

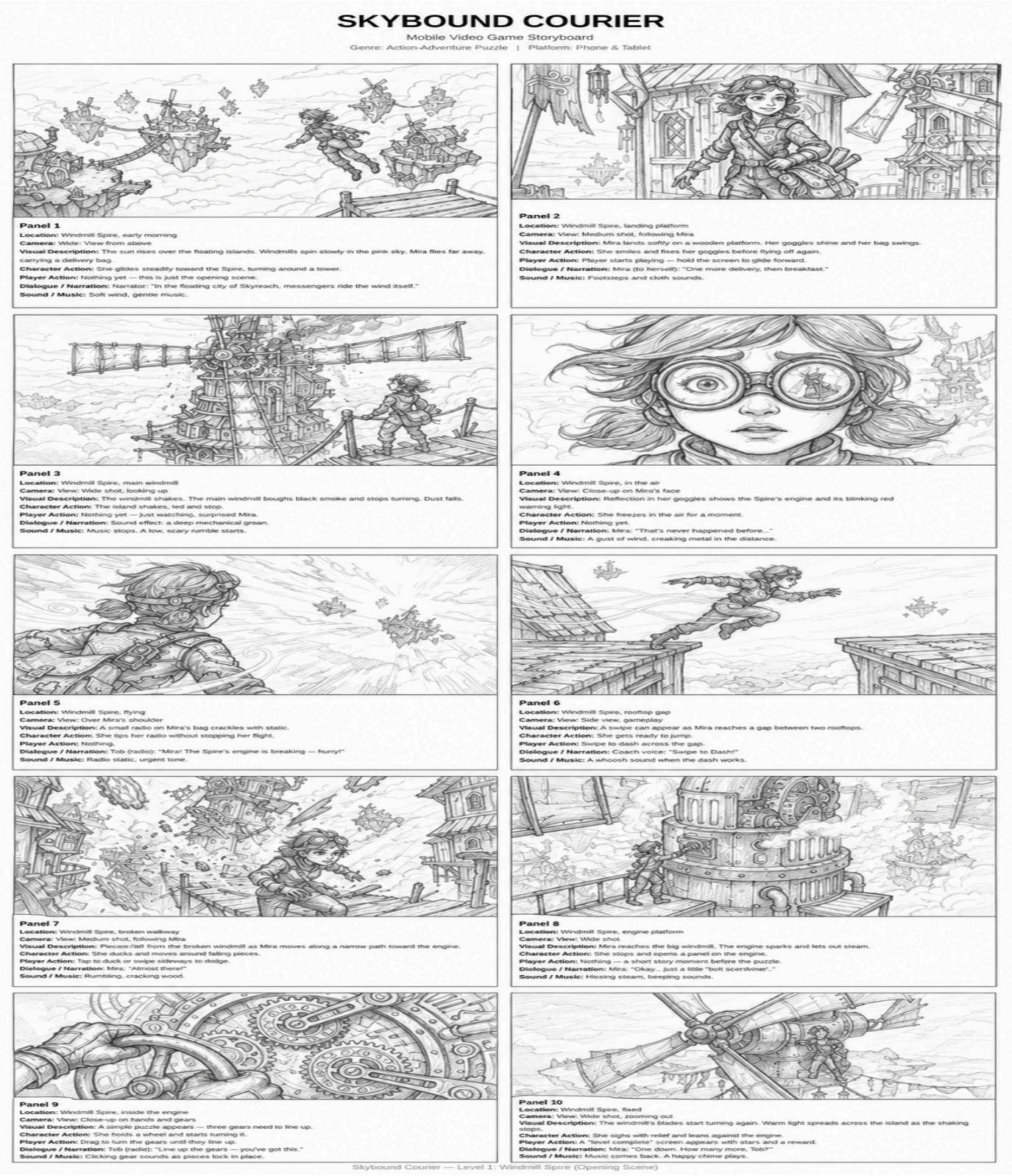
Shapes: ovals for start and end, rectangles for actions, a diamond for the question, and arrows to show the direction.



That's the Level 2 flowchart: start → goal → explore the market → the Windstone key check, splitting into the success run (redirect wind → reach trader → save trader → fight Wisps → win) or the retry loop (search side streets → dodge debris → back to exploring).

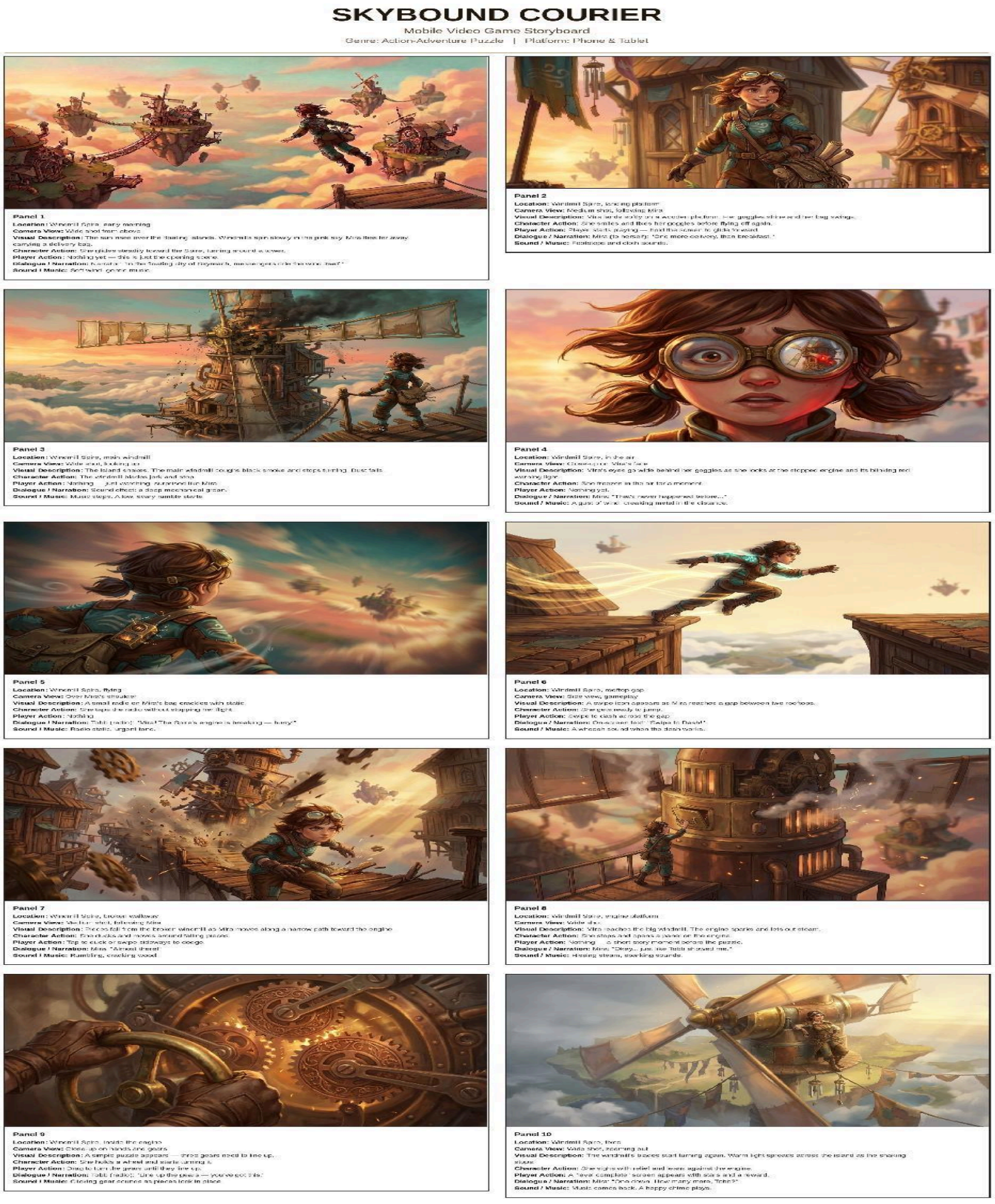
Part 10: Storyboard Panels

Hand-Drawn Storyboard Sketch



AI-Generated Storyboard Visuals

Full 10-panel storyboard with AI-generated illustrations, Level 1: Windmill Spire (Opening Scene).



Panel 1

Location: Windmill Spire, early morning
Camera View: Wide shot from above
What We See: The sun rises over the floating islands. Windmills spin slowly in the pink sky. Mira flies far away, carrying a delivery bag.
What Mira Does: She glides steadily toward the Spire, turning around a tower.
What the Player Does: Nothing yet — this is just the opening scene.
Words: Narrator: “In the floating city of Skyreach, messengers ride the wind itself.”
Sounds: Soft wind, gentle music.

Panel 2

Location: Windmill Spire, landing platform
Camera View: Medium shot, following Mira
What We See: Mira lands softly on a wooden platform. Her goggles shine and her bag swings.
What Mira Does: She smiles and fixes her goggles before flying off again.
What the Player Does: Player starts playing — hold the screen to glide forward.
Words: Mira (to herself): “One more delivery, then breakfast.”
Sounds: Footsteps and cloth sounds.

Panel 3

Location: Windmill Spire, main windmill
Camera View: Wide shot, looking up
What We See: The island shakes. The main windmill coughs black smoke and stops turning. Dust falls.
What Mira Does: The windmill blades jerk and stop.
What the Player Does: Nothing — just watching, surprised like Mira.
Words: Sound effect: a deep mechanical groan.
Sounds: Music stops. A low, scary rumble starts.

Panel 4

Location: Windmill Spire, in the air
Camera View: Close-up on Mira's face
What We See: Mira's eyes go wide behind her goggles as she looks at the stopped engine and its blinking red warning light.
What Mira Does: She freezes in the air for a moment.
What the Player Does: Nothing yet.
Words: Mira: “That's never happened before...”
Sounds: A gust of wind, creaking metal in the distance.

Panel 5

Location: Windmill Spire, flying
Camera View: Over Mira's shoulder
What We See: A small radio on Mira's bag crackles with static.
What Mira Does: She taps the radio without stopping her flight.
What the Player Does: Nothing.
Words: Tobb (radio): “Mira! The Spire's engine is breaking — hurry!”
Sounds: Radio static, urgent tone.

Panel 6

Location: Windmill Spire, rooftop gap
Camera View: Side view, gameplay
What We See: A swipe icon appears as Mira reaches a gap between two rooftops.
What Mira Does: She gets ready to jump.
What the Player Does: Swipe to dash across the gap.
Words: On-screen text: “Swipe to Dash!”
Sounds: A whoosh sound when the dash works.

Panel 7

Location: Windmill Spire, broken walkway
Camera View: Medium shot, following Mira
What We See: Pieces fall from the broken windmill as Mira moves along a narrow path toward the engine.
What Mira Does: She ducks and moves around falling pieces.
What the Player Does: Tap to duck or swipe sideways to dodge.
Words: Mira: “Almost there!”
Sounds: Rumbling, cracking wood.

Panel 8

Location: Windmill Spire, engine platform
Camera View: Wide shot
What We See: Mira reaches the big windmill. The engine sparks and lets out steam.
What Mira Does: She stops and opens an engine panel.
What the Player Does: Nothing — a short story moment before the puzzle.
Words: Mira: “Okay... just like Tobb showed me.”
Sounds: Hissing steam, sparking sounds.

Panel 9

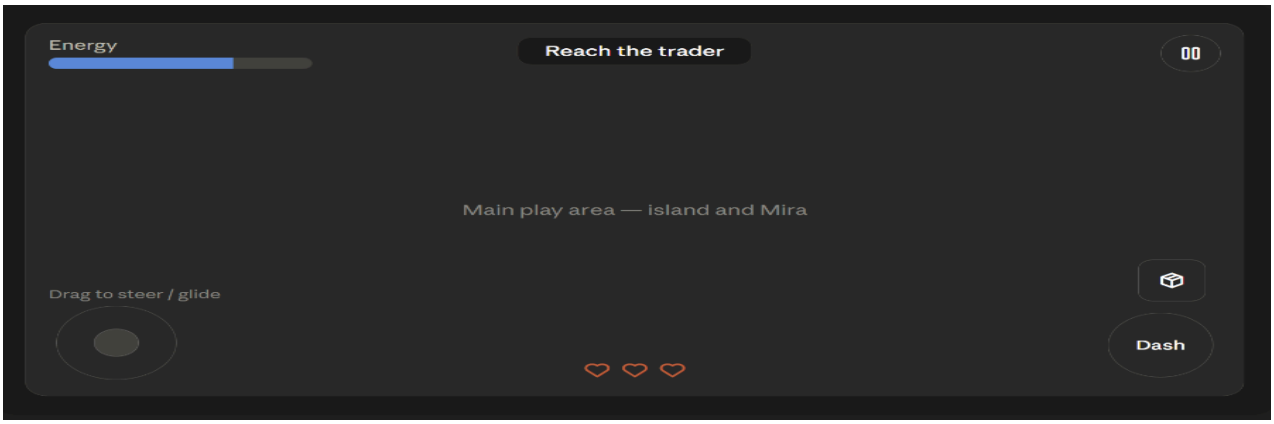
Location: Windmill Spire, inside the engine
Camera View: Close-up on hands and gears
What We See: A simple puzzle appears — three gears need to line up.
What Mira Does: She holds a wheel and starts turning it.
What the Player Does: Drag to turn the gears until they line up.
Words: Tobb (radio): “Line up the gears — you've got this.”
Sounds: Clicking gear sounds as pieces lock in place.

Panel 10

Location: Windmill Spire, fixed
Camera View: Wide shot, zooming out
What We See: The windmill's blades start turning again. Warm light spreads across the island as the shaking stops.
What Mira Does: She sighs with relief and leans against the engine.
What the Player Does: A “level complete” screen appears with stars and a reward.
Words: Mira: “One down. How many more, Tobb?”
Sounds: Music comes back. A happy chime plays.

Part 11: Mobile Screen Design

Screen layout, in words:



Top-left: Energy bar (how much Mira can glide)
Top-center: Current mission (what to do next)
Top-right: Pause button
Main play area: You see the island and Mira flying around
Bottom-left: Joystick or swipe area to steer while gliding
Bottom-center: Health/lives display
Bottom-right: Wind Dash button, with an item button just above it

Controls

Screen direction: Sideways (landscape)
Orientation: Landscape orientation
Input types used: Tap controls, swipe controls, drag controls

Main controls:

- Hold the screen to glide
- Swipe to Wind Dash
- Drag on the left side to steer

Extra controls:

- Tap the ability icon to open your items
- Drag gear pieces to turn them during engine puzzles

Why these controls work well on phones

Every action uses just one simple move — hold, swipe, or drag — so you can play with one hand and never have to look away to find a button.

The joystick and dash button sit in opposite corners, which matches how your thumbs naturally rest when holding the phone sideways.

The gear puzzles use the same drag motion you already learned while flying, so you never have to learn something new.

Each level only takes about 3 to 6 minutes, which fits well with quick mobile play, and the pause button is always easy to reach.

Submission Checklist

- Story idea and premise – done
- What the player becomes – done
- Four main game ideas – done
- Character profiles – done
- World description – done
- Beginning, middle, and end – done
- Five levels – done
- Gameplay steps – done
- Flowchart – done
- Ten storyboard panels – done
- Phone screen design – done